Kickoff · 12 June 2026

Project Northstar

Consolidating four sales tools into one CRM by year-end — here is the charter.

We are consolidating four sales tools into one CRM by 19 December.

Sales runs on four disconnected tools today. Northstar replaces them with a single CRM so reps stop re-keying data and leadership gets one source of pipeline truth.

This kickoff sets the charter: the why, the scope, the team, and the first decision.

The problem: four tools, no single view, hours lost to re-entry.

Reps maintain the same account in a CRM, a quoting tool, a spreadsheet, and an email plugin. Nothing syncs. Forecasts are reconciled by hand every Friday, and no one trusts the number the same way twice.

- The sales team estimates six hours per rep per week lost to duplicate data entry.
- Three of the last four board forecasts were revised after the fact.

The cost of fragmentation

6 hrs

lost per rep, per week, to duplicate entry

— across 90 reps, that is a full team

doing nothing but re-typing.

The charter: one CRM, one data model, live by 19 December.

Northstar delivers a single CRM with a unified account model, migrated history, and native quoting — replacing all four legacy tools. Success is measured by adoption and forecast trust, not by go-live alone.

- In scope: accounts, opportunities, quoting, and reporting.
- Out of scope: marketing automation and support ticketing — phase two.

What "done" must satisfy before we decommission anything.

01

Single source of truth

Every account, opportunity, and quote lives in one system with no shadow spreadsheets.

02

Clean migration

All open opportunities and two years of closed history move with zero data loss.

03

Reps actually use it

90% weekly active adoption across the sales org within four weeks of launch.

04

Forecast trust restored

Leadership reads one pipeline number that reconciles without manual adjustment.

Northstar · H2 2026

What ships in each phase, by workstream.

WORKSTREAM	FOUNDATION	BUILD	LAUNCH
	JUL	SEP	DEC
Data model	In flight — Unified schema	Planned — History migration	Planned — Cutover
Quoting	Planned — Requirements	Planned — Native quote build	Planned — Pilot
Reporting	Planned — Forecast spec	Planned — Dashboard build	Planned — Leadership rollout
Enablement	Planned — Comms plan	Planned — Training content	Planned — Org-wide training

In flight Planned

Who owns what on Northstar.

Sponsors the project and clears blockers — Dana Whitfield, VP Sales

Final escalation point; owns the go / no-go at each gate.

Runs delivery day to day — Marco Ruiz, Project Lead

Owns the plan, the standups, and the status you read each week.

Owns the data model and migration — Aisha Bello, Eng Lead

Accountable for schema, migration tooling, and zero-loss cutover.

Owns adoption and training — Tom Lindqvist, Enablement

Designs the rollout, the training, and the adoption metric.

How we will work together for the next six months.

Weekly status

A one-page written status every Friday, read before Monday's standup.

Decision log

Every scope or design decision is logged with its rationale and owner.

Two-week sprints

We plan and demo in two-week cycles; nothing waits a quarter for feedback.

Stage gates

Three go / no-go gates — after Foundation, Build, and before Launch.

Milestones · H2 2026

The dated path from kickoff to launch.

2026 Jul

Unified schema signed off

• decision

The single data model is agreed and frozen for build.

2026 Sep

Native quoting in pilot

• live

First reps quote inside the new CRM against real opportunities.

2026 Nov

History migrated and validated

✔ done

Two years of closed history move with a reconciled record count.

2026 Dec

Cutover and legacy retirement

• decision

All four legacy tools go read-only; Northstar is the system of record.

First decision: freeze the data model before any build starts.

FREEZE THE SCHEMA FIRST

Six weeks of design up front prevents months of rework downstream.

BUILD AND REFACTOR IN PARALLEL

Feels faster early, but every schema change ripples through migration and quoting.

Marco Ruiz · northstar@example.com

One CRM, one truth, live by year-end.